

Mesa 24.2 open source graphics stack released

The Mesa 24.2 open source graphics stack for Linux-based operating systems has officially been released, marking the second major update in the Mesa 24.x series. Mesa 24.2 introduces several key features and improvements, including new Vulkan extensions for the RADV (Radeon Vulkan) graphics driver. These extensions include `VK_KHR_dynamic_rendering_local_read`, `VK_EXT_legacy_vertex_attributes`, `VK_MESA_image_alignment_control`, `VK_KHR_maintenance7`, and `VK_EXT_shader_replicated_composites`. Additionally, the RADV driver now supports 10-bit colour depth.

The update also extends support for the `VK_EXT_legacy_vertex_attributes` Vulkan extension across other drivers, including ANV (Intel Vulkan), Lavapipe, and Turnip. Moreover, the `VK_EXT_shader_replicated_composites` Vulkan extension is now supported on ANV, Dozen, HasVK, Lavapipe, NVK, and Turnip drivers. Mesa 24.2 further enhances the V3DV driver with support for the `VK_KHR_maintenance5` and `VK_EXT_depth_clamp_zero_one` Vulkan extensions. The V3D driver also gains support for the `GL_ARB_depth_clamp` OpenGL extension. Additionally, this release introduces a new default shader cache implementation designed to reduce file system overhead.

As with previous major Mesa releases, version 24.2 brings improved support for a variety of video games. Notable titles that benefit from this update include Counter-Strike 2, Dota 2, Worms: Revolution, Asterix & Obelix XXL: Romastered, Metal Gear Rising: Revengeance, Fallout 3, Starfield, Far Cry, Cyberpunk 2077, Total War: Warhammer III, God of War, Borderlands, and Enshrouded.

This release enhances compatibility with recent versions of Blender, particularly for systems using RDNA3 cards and the Nouveau driver. Support for GNOME Shell on Wayland has been improved, along with enhanced support for the AMD Radeon RX 7600, RX 6400, and RX 7900 XTX GPUs. Numerous bug fixes have also been included to ensure a smoother experience for users.

Free Software Foundation closes its office and goes fully remote

On August 31, 2024, the Free Software Foundation (FSF) closed its office for the last time as the organisation went fully remote.

The Free Software Foundation was founded by Richard Stallman on October 4, 1985, to support the then burgeoning free software movement. About four months later, Stallman wrote and FSF published the Free Software Definition, which led to the creation of the GNU General Public License in 1989.



Stallman led the organisation for many years and is still active as a board member.

In an email exchange, FSF's executive director Zoë Kooyman told *FOSS Force* that like many organisations, FSF's move to remote began during the Covid pandemic.

"During Covid staff went remote and only few came back to the office after that," she said. "During this time the FSF became an organisation effective at doing our advocacy from multiple time zones. The in-person part of our work is only now picking back up and might never completely be the same. Having less people in an office that was already big for us is not sustainable."

The blog post on fsf.org reads "We've immensely enjoyed our nineteen years at 51 Franklin Street and have made so many wonderful memories here. We've celebrated many GNU and FSF birthdays, created signs for our multiple protests, and spent time together before and after multiple LibrePlanet conferences at our beloved office. We've gotten to meet and team up with so many amazing volunteers here, as well as welcome countless visitors to the FSF. We're so grateful for the many years that we called 51 Franklin Street our home, but the time has come for a change."

"After August 31st, we will no longer be residing at our office on 51 Franklin Street. There were many factors that led to this decision, and while some of them were out of our control, we're very excited for this new chapter in the FSF. We are confident that shifting to a remote working model will strengthen the FSF and empower us to continue advocating for user freedom long into the future."

Kooyman explained that the decision to become fully remote made sense for several reasons. Many of the projects that the FSF collaborates with have traditionally operated primarily or entirely remotely. The increasing cost of real estate also influenced the decision, as remote work not only reduces these expenses but also saves money for FSF employees.